REPUBLIC OF BOTSWANA

MINISTRY OF ENVIRONMENT AND TOURISM

Nezara viridula

Order: HEMIPTERA
Family: PENTATOMIDAE
Species: Nezara Viridula
Local name: Podile
Common name: Stink bugs

Insect of the month

July 2025

This month we shine the spotlight on one of nature's pungent little creatures- the stink bugs. For the month of May, stink bugs have been the subject of increased sightings across Botswana, appearing in workplaces and homes alike, with people taking to social media about this unusual and yet, not so strange occurrence with the approach of winter.

Description: stink bugs are recognised by their shield shaped bodies and by the unpleasant odour they release when threatened or disturbed – a defence mechanism that gave origin to their unique name. While some species are herbivorous pests that can cause damage to crops, others are predatory, feeding on other insects thus playing a role in natural pest control. This just goes to show the diversity within this family and highlights their noteworthy presence in the local ecosystem.

Fun facts:

Scent defence: Their trademark smell comes from glands located on their abdomen. This scent is non-toxic to humans but pungent enough to deter any would be attackers.

Feeding habits: Stink bugs feed on a wide variety of plants, using their needle like mouthparts to suck juices from plants, fruits and vegetables.

Winter hideouts: When cool weather approaches, these smart bugs often seek warm places to hibernate – often times choosing our homes as shelter away from the cold.

OPENING HOURS
Monday to Friday 0730 - 1800hrs
Saturday and Sunday 0730 - 1800hrs
Public Holiday 0800 - 1800hrs

BOTSWANA national museum

national botanical garden

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